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Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Submitter Information

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General Comment

"Unnecessarily burdensome requirements" is incredibly alarming terminology to use here. These models exist on the backs of creators: authors, photographers, artists, musicians, songwriters, playwrights. In most contexts, we compensate these people for their work. We make some exceptions for criticism, for education, or for significantly transformative work. In my opinion, none of this applies to training generative AI.

I fail to understand the point of allowing these companies to continue to scrape data with impunity. The only point I can see is greed. The greed of taking something that is not theirs and feeding it into an algorithm so it can make counterfeit copies of what they've stolen for profit. I understand that generative AI seems flashy and new and exciting. I find it rather soulless. I find it hard to care at all about books no one cared to write, or about paintings no one bothered to paint.

I do not discount all AI innovation, but I think it could be better served in a position that doesn't drive creatives out of their respective fields chasing the cheapest alternative. If they want to scrape everything off the internet without paying for it, then they should not be able to profit with what comes out of it. Or if they do, then they must compensate all those who were forced unwittingly into their data set.

If it's not clear, I oppose this. These regulations are necessary. If AI is not capable of continuing to grow or advance without mass scraping of copyrighted content, then it is a flaw in their system, not the fault of those who have been stolen from.